

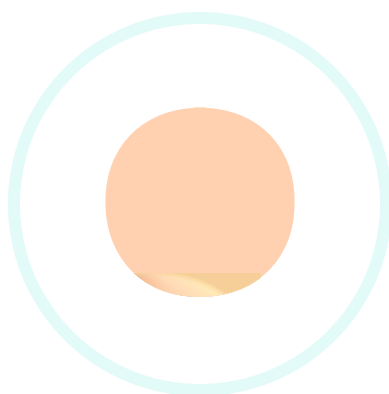


The Khan Family & Cookbook

recipes, memories & a little chaos

in the kitchen, together

A collection by **Noor & Yahya Khan**



Breads & Bakes

Warm from the tawa or the oven.

IN THIS SECTION

Breads & Bakes

Where precision pays off — scales, timers, and a thermometer that actually gets used.

Munshi Naan

Yahya

Everyday Loaf

Yahya

BREADS & BAKES · YEASTED

Munshi *Naan*

***Soft, pillowy, and weighed to the gram.** The yogurt is what keeps the crumb tender instead of bready, and the ghee off the heat gives it that glossy, restaurant-style finish. Measured, not guessed — so it comes out the same every time.*

from the kitchen of Yahya

MUNSHI NAAN



main photo — the finished naan ♦

fresh off the tava



side photo ♦

the risen dough



side photo ♦

rolled and ready

Munshi Naan

from the kitchen of Yahya

MAKES 4 • RISE 60–90 MIN • COOK 2–3 MIN EACH

INGREDIENTS

All-Purpose Flour	240 g	Warm Milk (or water)	120 g
Active Dry Yeast (Khamir)	3 g	Salt	4.5 g
Sugar	4 g	Plain Yogurt	30 g
Ghee (or melted butter)	14 g		

Milk warm, not hot — ~105°F (40°C). Above 115°F (46°C) kills the yeast.

METHOD

- 1 Bloom the yeast.** Stir the yeast and sugar into the warm milk (120 g, ~105°F). Stand 5–10 min until foamy.
- 2 Mix.** Combine flour (240 g) and salt (4.5 g). Add the yogurt (30 g), ghee (14 g) and yeast milk. Mix to a shaggy dough.
- 3 Knead.** 8–10 min by hand until smooth, soft and slightly tacky — it should spring back when pressed.
- 4 First rise.** Cover and rest in a warm spot 60–90 min, until doubled.
- 5 Divide & shape.** Knock back, divide into 4 (~102 g each). Ball, cover, rest 10 min.
- 6 Roll.** Roll each into a teardrop ~8 in long, ~1/4 in thick.
- 7 Cook hot.** Screaming-hot tava, 2–3 min total — flip once big bubbles form and it's charred in spots.
- 8 Finish.** Brush with ghee off the heat; keep wrapped in a towel so they stay soft.

Yahya's note: weigh everything. The yogurt is not optional — it's what makes the crumb tender. If the dough fights the roll, rest it another 5 min.

MORE FROM THIS BAKE

side photo ✦

blooming the yeast

side photo ✦

kneaded smooth

side photo ✦

bubbling on the tava

side photo ✦

brushed with ghee

BREADS & BAKES · 64% HYDRATION

Everyday *Loaf*

***The dough that does everything.** Built on a baker's formula at 64% hydration — soft enough for sandwiches, sturdy enough to shape free-form. The percentages are by weight of flour, so scale it up or down and it stays true.*

from the kitchen of Yahya

EVERYDAY LOAF



main photo — the finished loaf ♦

deep golden, cooled on a rack



side photo ♦

dough doubled



side photo ♦

the crumb

Everyday *Loaf*

from the kitchen of Yahya

1 LOAF • RISE 2 HRS • BAKE 30–35 MIN • 375°F (190°C)

FORMULA • 1 LOAF

Flour (AP or bread)	375 g • 100%	Sugar (or Honey)	12 g • 3.2%
Water (warm)	240 g • 64%	Salt	9 g • 2.4%
Butter or Oil	14 g • 3.7%	Active Dry Yeast	7 g • 1.9%
Total Dough		657 g • 175.2%	

Hydration = water ÷ flour × 100 = 64%. Aim for a final dough temp of 76–78°F (24–26°C).

METHOD

- 1 Bloom the yeast.** Stir yeast (7 g) and sugar (12 g) into warm water (240 g). Rest 5–10 min until foamy.
- 2 Mix.** Combine flour (375 g) and salt (9 g). Add the yeast water and butter or oil (14 g). Mix to a rough dough.
- 3 Knead.** 10 min by hand until smooth and elastic — it should pass a windowpane test.
- 4 Bulk rise.** Cover and ferment ~1 hr at warm room temperature, until doubled.
- 5 Shape.** Degas, shape into a tight loaf, seam-side down in a greased 9×5 in pan.
- 6 Proof.** Cover and proof 45–60 min, until it crowns ~1 in above the rim.
- 7 Bake.** 375°F (190°C) for 30–35 min, until deep golden and 200–205°F (93–96°C) inside.
- 8 Cool.** Turn out and cool on a rack at least 1 hr before slicing.

Yahya's note: the loaf is done when the thermometer says so, not when the timer rings. 64% hydration is forgiving — but weigh it either way.

MORE FROM THIS BAKE

side photo ✦

shaped in the pan

side photo ✦

proofed and risen

side photo ✦

fresh from the oven

side photo ✦

the first slice



Salans

Gravies that make the rice make sense.

IN THIS SECTION

Salans

The gravies and curries — slow-built masalas that make a plate of rice make sense.

Bhendi Ghosht

Noor

SALANS · MUTTON

Bhendi *Ghosht*

***Mutton and okra in a tangy, whole-spice gravy.** The meat is pressure-cooked soft with tomatoes, tamarind and whole garam spices, then the bhendi goes in at the end so it keeps its bite. Tangy, a little rich, and made for a big plate of hot rice.*

from the kitchen of Noor

BHENDI GHOSHT

main photo — the finished curry ♦

mutton and okra in tangy gravy

side photo ♦

onions & whole spices

side photo ♦

bhendi going in

Bhendi *Ghosht*

from the kitchen of Noor

A HEARTY POT FOR THE FAMILY • PRESSURE-COOKED, THEN FINISHED

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- mutton (goat), cut into pieces
- bhendi (okra / ladies finger), trimmed
- onions, chopped
- tomatoes, chopped
- ginger-garlic paste, a good spoon
- whole spices — cloves (long) & cinnamon
- oil, a generous pour
- turmeric (haldi), a pinch
- red chili powder (mirchi), to taste
- coriander powder (dhania)
- salt (namak), to taste
- tamarind — paste, or concentrate in water
- garam masala powder
- curry leaves • coriander leaves • green chilies

Amounts by feel. Pressure-cook time depends on the meat: ~22 min for smallish pieces, ~35 min for larger ones.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Fry the onions.** Heat oil and fry the chopped onions until golden brown.
- 2 Whole spices.** Add the cloves and cinnamon, then the ginger-garlic paste; fry until the raw smell is gone.
- 3 Tomatoes.** Add the chopped tomatoes and fry until softened and pulpy.
- 4 Brown the mutton.** Add the mutton pieces and fry a little. Add turmeric, chili powder, salt, then coriander powder.
- 5 Add tamarind & water.** Add a little water plus tamarind paste (or tamarind concentrate in water). Stir.
- 6 Pressure-cook.** Cook the meat until tender — ~22 min for small pieces, ~35 min for larger.
- 7 Add the bhendi.** Stir in the okra with a sprinkle of garam masala, curry leaves, coriander leaves and green chilies.
- 8 Finish.** Cook until the bhendi is tender (or pressure-cook 5–10 min more). Serve hot with rice.

Amma's note: add the bhendi only after the meat is cooked so it keeps its shape and doesn't go slimy. The tamarind is what makes it tangy — start small and adjust.

MORE FROM THIS DISH



tomatoes frying down



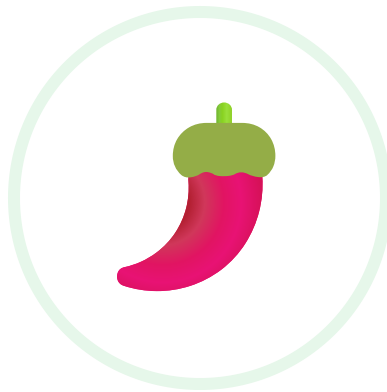
mutton browning



after the pressure cook



plated with rice



Chutneys

The little jars that carry the meal.

IN THIS SECTION

Chutneys

The tangy little sides — ground, tempered, and made to carry a plate of rice.

Palak Ulikaram

Noor

Kakdi Chutney

Noor

CHUTNEYS · ANDHRA

Palak *Ulikaram*

Spinach cooked down with a tangy, garlicky Andhra masala — roasted chilies and coriander ground with tamarind and a whole lot of garlic, then simmered into the greens until the oil comes shining back to the top. Eat it with hot white rice and a spoon of ghee, and don't count the garlic cloves.

from the kitchen of Noor

PALAK ULIKARAM



main photo — the finished dish ♦

dark, glossy, and ready for rice



side photo ♦

the ground masala



side photo ♦

spinach going in

Palak *Ulikaram*

from the kitchen of Noor

A BIG BOWL FOR THE FAMILY • A TANGY AFTERNOON DISH

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

FOR THE GROUND MASALA

- 1 big onion, roughly chopped
- a fistful of garlic cloves
- a lime-sized ball of tamarind
- a good handful of dried red chilies
- 2–3 spoons coriander seeds (dhania)
- a spoon of cumin (zira)
- salt, to taste

FOR THE TEMPERING & GREENS

- oil, a generous pour
- mustard seeds & cumin (zira)
- chana dal & urad dal, a spoon each
- a sprig of curry leaves
- a pinch of asafoetida (hing)
- red chili powder, to your bravery
- turmeric (haldi), a good pinch
- lots & lots of spinach, chopped
- coriander leaves, to finish
- ghee, for serving

Amounts are by feel — start with more garlic and chili than seems wise, then taste as you go.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Roast the whole spices.** Lightly dry-sauté the dried red chilies, coriander seeds and cumin until warm and toasty — don't burn them.
- 2 Grind.** Blend the onion, garlic, tamarind, salt and the roasted spices to a coarse paste.
- 3 Temper.** Heat oil; add mustard seeds, cumin, chana dal, urad dal and curry leaves. Let it splutter and the dals turn golden; add a pinch of hing.
- 4 Fry the paste.** Add the ground masala and fry a few minutes until it darkens and the oil separates.
- 5 Spice it.** Add chili powder, turmeric and a little more salt if needed.
- 6 Cook the spinach.** Add lots of chopped spinach. Cook and cook until the water is gone and the oil separates again.
- 7 Finish.** Stir through coriander leaves. Serve with hot rice and ghee.

Amma's note: the whole secret is patience at the end — keep cooking until the oil comes back. And add more garlic than you think.

MORE FROM THIS DISH

side photo ♦

roasting the chilies

side photo ♦

the coarse paste

side photo ♦

oil separating

side photo ♦

plated with rice

CHUTNEYS · CUCUMBER

Kakdi *Chutney*

Tangy, lightly spicy, a little sweet. A cucumber chutney made with slightly raw kakdi — cooked down with tomato, tamarind and green chili, ground coarse with raw garlic, then a handful of raw diced kakdi stirred back in for those bright, crunchy, tangy bites. Wonderful with white rice, a fried protein, or an omelet.

from the kitchen of Noor

KAKDI CHUTNEY

main photo — the finished chutney ♦

coarse, tangy, flecked with raw kakdi

side photo ♦

the raw kakdi, diced small

side photo ♦

served with rice

Kakdi *Chutney*

from the kitchen of Noor

A BOWLFUL • TANGY, LIGHTLY SPICY & A LITTLE SWEET

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- 3–4 kakdi (cucumber), slightly raw — half green, firm to the touch
- 2–3 tomatoes
- green chilies, a few
- tamarind — a small ball, or a big spoon of concentrate
- a whole head of raw garlic
- oil, for the pan
- cumin seeds (zira)
- salt (namak), to taste

Pick kakdi that's slightly hard to the touch — never soft. Don't use any that's gone soft. Amounts by feel.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Prep the kakdi.** Peel and deseed. Dice about a quarter of it very small and set aside raw — these go in at the end for tangy, crunchy bites. Cut the rest into slices or cubes.
- 2 Start the pan.** Heat oil and let the cumin seeds splutter.
- 3 Cook it down.** Add the cut kakdi, chopped tomatoes, green chilies and tamarind. Cover and cook until all the vegetables are fully soft.
- 4 Cool it.** Let the cooked mixture cool down before grinding.
- 5 Grind coarse.** In a mixer, put the raw garlic, the cooled mixture and salt. Grind just a few seconds — leave it slightly coarse, not a smooth paste.
- 6 Stir in the raw kakdi.** Tip into a bowl and mix in the reserved raw diced kakdi. Ready to eat.

Amma's note: the raw kakdi stirred in at the end is the whole trick — don't skip it, that's where the bright tangy crunch comes from. Keep the grind coarse, not smooth.

MORE FROM THIS DISH

side photo ✦

peeled & deseeded kakdi

side photo ✦

cooking with tomato & tamarind

side photo ✦

ground coarse with garlic

side photo ✦

with rice and an omelet



Seafood

From the coast, cooked with care.

IN THIS SECTION

Seafood

Prawns and fish, cooked quick and hot — big flavour with a squeeze and a pickle.

Jhinga Achari Fry	Noor
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Jhinga Palak	Noor
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SEAFOOD · ACHARI

Jhinga *Achari* Fry

Prawns marinated in a pickle-spiced masala, then fried till they catch at the edges. The spoonful of achar — mango, tomato, whatever's open in the fridge — is the trick: it gives the whole thing that tangy, pickly kick. Wonderful with rice and dal, or just rice and a bit of chutney.

from the kitchen of Noor

JHINGA ACHARI FRY



main photo — the finished fry ♦

crisp at the edges, curry leaves and all



side photo ♦

prawns marinating



side photo ♦

sizzling in the pan

Jhinga *Achari* Fry

from the kitchen of Noor

A PLATEFUL OF PRAWNS · QUICK FRY, BIG FLAVOUR

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

PRAWNS & MARINADE

- prawns (jhinga), heads & tails off, washed
- ginger-garlic paste, a good spoon
- turmeric (haldi), a pinch
- red chili powder (mirchi), to taste
- salt (namak), to taste
- coriander powder (dhania) — a little extra
- cumin powder (jeera)
- kalonji (black seeds)
- cumin seeds (zira)
- a spoon of achar — mango, tomato or mixed-veg

FRYING & FINISHING

- oil, for a hot shallow fry
- a sprig of curry leaves
- chopped coriander leaves, to garnish

Any pickle works — the achar is what makes it "achari." Start with a small spoon and taste.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Prep the prawns.** Remove the heads and tails, then wash well and drain.
- 2 Marinate.** Add ginger-garlic paste, turmeric, chili powder, salt, extra coriander powder and cumin powder. Then the kalonji and cumin seeds.
- 3 The achari touch.** Stir in a spoon of achar. Mix well and let it marinate a while.
- 4 Heat the oil.** Get the oil hot and drop in the curry leaves to crackle.
- 5 Fry the prawns.** Lay them in one by one and fry, turning, until cooked through and catching at the edges.
- 6 Finish.** Garnish with coriander leaves. Serve hot with rice and dal, or rice and chutney.

Amma's note: don't crowd the pan — lay the prawns in one by one so they fry, not steam. And don't overcook; prawns are done the moment they curl and turn opaque.

MORE FROM THIS DISH

side photo ♦

cleaned prawns

side photo ♦

the achari masala

side photo ♦

curry leaves crackling

side photo ♦

plated with rice

SEAFOOD · QUICK

Jhinga *Palak*

Shrimp and spinach, done in one quick pan. No grinding, no fuss — just golden onions, spinach cooked down till it's wilted and dry, and jumbo shrimp slipped in at the very end so they stay plump and tender. A weeknight dish that tastes like you tried harder than you did.

from the kitchen of Noor

JHINGA PALAK



plump shrimp in wilted greens



shrimp curled and just done

side photo ♦

straight from the pan

Jhinga *Palak*

from the kitchen of Noor

A QUICK WEEKNIGHT PAN • READY IN ABOUT 20 MINUTES

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- jumbo shrimp, tails & shells off, cleaned
- a lot of spinach (palak), chopped
- 1 onion, chopped
- ginger-garlic paste, a good spoon
- olive oil, for frying
- salt (namak), to taste
- turmeric (haldi), a pinch
- red chili powder (mirchi), to taste
- coriander powder (dhania)

Extra-large / jumbo shrimp hold up best — they stay plump in the quick cook. Amounts by feel; taste as you go.

HOW WE MAKE IT

- 1 Fry the onions.** Heat olive oil and fry the chopped onion until lightly golden brown.
- 2 Ginger-garlic.** Add the ginger-garlic paste and fry with the onions until the raw smell is gone.
- 3 Add the palak.** Tip in lots of chopped spinach along with salt, turmeric, chili powder and coriander powder.
- 4 Cook it down.** Cook and cook until all the water from the spinach is gone and it's wilted and cooked through.
- 5 Add the shrimp.** Slip in the cleaned jumbo shrimp and cook quickly — about 2 minutes — just until they turn opaque and are done.
- 6 Serve.** That's it. Lovely with rice or roti.

Amma's note: the shrimp go in last and cook fast — two minutes, no more. Overcooked shrimp turn rubbery, so pull the pan the moment they curl and turn opaque.

MORE FROM THIS DISH



side photo ✦

cleaned jumbo shrimp



side photo ✦

palak cooking down



side photo ✦

shrimp just added



side photo ✦

plated with rice